Equivalent & Simplified Fractions

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Equivalent fractions

What are equivalent fractions?

- **Equivalent fractions** are two fractions that represent the **same amount**
  - They are different ways of writing the same thing
  - For example, $\frac{1}{2}$ and $\frac{6}{12}$ are equivalent fractions

How do I find an equivalent fraction?

- To find an equivalent fraction, **multiply the top and bottom** of a fraction by the same number
  - $\frac{5}{6}$ is equivalent to $\frac{5 \times 2}{6 \times 2} = \frac{10}{12}$ and $\frac{5 \times 3}{6 \times 3} = \frac{15}{18}$ and $\frac{5 \times 4}{6 \times 4} = \frac{20}{24}$ etc.
  - For each fraction, there are an **infinite number** of equivalent fractions

Examiner Tips and Tricks

Using **equivalent fractions** can help with shading parts of diagrams questions as well as adding and subtracting fractions without a calculator.

Remember that if you have your **calculator** in the exam you can use it to check your work.

Help me understand

Stuck on something?

Ask questions and get help with exactly what you're revising.

Got it

Simplifying fractions

What is a simplified fraction?

- A **simplified fraction** is a fraction that is written using the **smallest** possible **integer values**

the **same number** (called a **common factor**), the fraction can be **simplified**
- Simplifying is also called **cancelling** a fraction

How do I simplify fractions?

- To simplify the fraction, **divide the top and bottom** by the common factor
- $\frac{12}{18} = \frac{12 \div 6}{18 \div 6} = \frac{2}{3}$
- $\frac{25}{45} = \frac{25 \div 5}{45 \div 5} = \frac{5}{9}$

Examiner Tips and Tricks

Make use of your calculator if you have it in your exam.

Type any fraction into it and pressing equals will automatically simplify the fraction for you

If the question asks you to show your working, you must show which number you divided by.

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